

VINFAST VF7

about 450 km (431-450 km WLTP estimated). While the VF7 is equipped with CCS2 charging ports and will be able to take high-speed DC charging, AC charging is limited to 7.2kW, and that for a battery size upwards of 70kWh would mean a whole night of charging at home. The VinFast team is looking at upgrading this to an 11kW on-board charger.

The larger wheelbase, as well as the fact that it is built on a dedicated electric platform, means that there is a lot of space, both in terms of leg room and shoulder room. And it is loaded with tech—up to the gills. A large 12.9-inch infotainment display performs some of the functions of the IP and takes centrestage on the dashboard. While most of the functions are provided on the touch screen, there are 5 switches that can be configured to provide access to whatever feature one wants. There is also a very large panoramic glass roof, but that is without a cover of any sort, and VinFast engineers assure us that collapsible screens will be available as accessories to cover up the large glass area for the summer. While the boot is a rather large 537 litres, and includes a puncture repair kit, it is not clear whether VinFast will equip the car with a space saver, though it has done so in some other markets.

As far as ADAS (Advanced Driver Assistance Systems) go, the VF7 stops just short of driving by itself and has a whole host of driver assistance systems, including highway and lane-keep assist, and an adaptive cruise control system. The car also has 360-degree surround view as well as rear parking assistance. It has a slew of connected features such as the operation of the HVAC system, opening of windows and locking/unlocking of doors, all through the app. There is also wireless Apple CarPlay as well as Android Auto. There are even seven airbags on the cars, and the VinFast engineering team assures us that the cars will get a 5-star rating at BNCAP.

The brutal acceleration of electric powertrains is very much present, but the car cannot handle the surge of power as the suspension is tuned more towards ride comfort than razor-sharp handling. Regen modes abound from no regen to low, medium and high, but even the highest regen setting does not translate into single pedal driving. The powertrain also has three driving modes, Eco, Normal and Sport, though the difference in the three does not seem to be of a large magnitude. ■



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